

Home to School Transport

Concessionary transport: North Somerset does not provide transport beyond the compulsory age of 16, except for those with special needs. There is a concessionary travel scheme whereby a student not entitled to transport may be able to take up a spare seat on a hired vehicle. Please contact North Somerset School home to school transport department, on 01934 634715.

School coach service: The school runs a paying coach service covering South Bristol and Long Ashton. Sixth Form students are also welcome to apply for a place on one of these buses. Places are limited and offered on a first-come, first-served basis. Please see the Travel to School page of the Backwell School website for more information and how to apply.

Public Bus: Most students travelling by bus from Bristol or Weston obtain a First student bus pass. These can be bought via the First Group website, <https://www.firstbus.co.uk/buy-tickets/ways-pay/students>

Students in full time education can obtain up to 10% discount on all tickets across the West of England (Bristol, Bath, Weston-super-Mare and Wells). Students must show a form of valid photo ID to the driver on every journey to receive the discount, e.g., a valid NUS card. For further information, visit <https://www.firstbus.co.uk/bristol-bath-and-west/tickets/ticket-types/young-person-16-21-students>

Train: For students wishing to travel by train, substantial savings can be made on the cost of travel. Students aged 16 and 17 are eligible for the 16-17 Saver for £35 per year, which will allow them 50% discount off standard Anytime, Off-Peak, Advance and Season tickets. It is valid for one year or until their 18th birthday, whichever comes first. They must keep it with them when they travel (on their phone or wallet). For further information and to apply for a 16-17 Saver, visit <https://www.16-17saver.co.uk/>

GWR offer a Scholar Season ticket for 16 to 17 year olds who are in full-time study. The Scholar Season ticket is valid for a specific, regular journey to and from school/college every day, and can be bought either termly, or as a block of three terms

(Term 1 is from September to December; Term 2 is from January to Easter and Term 3 is from Easter to July). It must be purchased before the student's 18th birthday and offers a substantial saving on the price of an equivalent standard Adult Season ticket. If you are interested in purchasing a GWR Scholar Season ticket, you will need to call GWR direct on 0345 766 0228 (Option 2). This line is available between 8.00 am and 6.00 pm, from Monday to Friday. Alternatively, you can apply by email to business.direct@gwr.com, stating both your departure and destination station. Payment can be made by credit or debit card. Generally, to enjoy the best discount on the cost of a Scholar Season ticket, it is worth purchasing the 16-17 Saver. GWR will be able to confirm this when you contact them. If you buy a Scholar Season ticket before your 16-17 Saver expires, you can keep using the season ticket for up to four months after the expiry.

For students aged 18 and over, it may be worth considering purchasing an Adult Season ticket to save substantially on the cost of a regular train journey. For further information, visit <https://www.gwr.com/your-tickets/choosing-your-ticket/season-tickets>

Students may also wish to consider buying a 16-25 Railcard, which will give 1/3 off standard rail tickets (but not season tickets); this costs £35 for a year. However, we would point out that this discount does not apply for journeys before 10.00 am Monday to Friday (a minimum fare of £12 is payable), so it is therefore not very useful for school travel. For more information and details on how to apply, please visit <https://www.16-25railcard.co.uk/>

Car and Motorcycle parking: Students may only park a car or motorcycle in school with a valid permit, obtained from the Sixth Form Office. Please be aware that parking space is extremely limited and in practice permits are only issued to students in Year 13 who are unable to use public transport. Priority is always given to students with a greater distance to travel, and we encourage lift sharing. Due to the obvious health and safety implications, there are rules concerning driving on the school site that are discussed upon issue of the permit. Failure to adhere to these rules will see the permit withdrawn.

